

## Delaware County Council Meeting April 22nd 2025

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BAKdjtnPyq8">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BAKdjtnPyq8</a> |
| Publication Date | 2025-04-23T02:44:23Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | delaware_county                                                                                       |

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## Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

**Meeting Date:** April 22, 2025

**Presiding Officer:** President Freeman

### 1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript does not indicate any statutory public hearings or committee work sessions held prior to calling the regular meeting to order.

### 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** **00:00:22** The Delaware County Council regular meeting was called to order on April 22, 2025, at 9:02 a.m. by President Freeman, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Gavin Green.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Mr. Brook, Mr. Mole, Mr. Hughes, Mr. Pants, Ms. Piper (or Spiper/Fiver), President Freeman, and Ms. Langan. (Note: Audio adjustments were made to ensure remote/attending council member Mr. Pants was clearly heard and visible).
  - **Absent:** None explicitly noted.

### 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** 00:00:28 Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
  - **Approval of Agenda:** 00:01:10 Motion to approve the agenda made by Dan, seconded by Jessica; passed by roll call vote.
  - **Approval of Minutes:** 00:02:08 Motion to approve the March meeting minutes made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; passed by roll call vote.
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### 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:33 Delaware County Housing Authority Update**
  - **Presenter:** Mr. Bowers and Executive Director Noe Moreno.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Provided an overview of the Housing Authority (Middletown Gardens), managing 162 public housing units (112 built in the 1930s, 50 in the 1980s) operating at 98% lease-up. Noted plans to master-plan redevelop the 1930s units and rehabilitate the 1980s units (which lack central AC and washer/dryer hookups). They also administer a Section 8 program with 175 families outside Muncie city limits. Total staff consists of 8 full-time and 1 part-time maintenance employee. Board members and staff are heavily committed, attending mandatory training.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation only; no formal vote taken.
- **00:09:08 Yorktown Public Library Board Appointment**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** President Freeman / Library Board Director Liz Roselle.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Carolyn Klein Gant was nominated for appointment to the Yorktown Public Library Board.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to appoint made by Brad, seconded by Jessica; approved by roll call vote.
- **00:09:56 County Redevelopment Commission TIF Presentation**
  - **Presenter:** Matt Eckerley (Baker Tilly Financial Advisor).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the 2024 TIF Management Report and the look-forward TIF allocation report covering the county's 27 allocation areas. Highlighted the impacts of recent legislation (Senate Enrolled Act 1) on property taxes and TIF revenues, noting that TIF operates on assessed values rather than direct revenue windfalls and functions to place downward pressure on property tax rates. Discussed debt obligations, emphasizing that Delaware County taxpayers are fully protected because debt is solely secured by tax increment or private developer shortfall agreements. Noted that certain areas (such as Midwest Metal) are fully paid off and have unobligated funds available for future strategic economic development.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation and statutory report filing; no formal board action required.

- **00:43:08 Sheriff's Department Financial Transfer**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff Tony Skinner.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** **00:43:36** Request to transfer \$300,000 from the jail food line item (223) to contractual services (31) to fund a new food service vendor contract (Victas Food Service). The vendor will prepare meals and hire current county cooks as their employees.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; approved by roll call vote.
- **00:44:56 Court / Commission Financial Transfer (Prorated Longevity Correction)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** **00:45:57** Technical corrections adjusting longevity pay lines (182, 184, 176) and equipment lines for prorated pay, along with line items for assistant court reporter, court reporter, and master commissioner.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; approved by roll call vote.
- **00:48:01 CASA Grant Financial Transfer**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** **00:49:51** Transferred \$17,000 from professional legal fees to the program director salary line to restructure the CASA director position into an attorney-required role, pending state budget outcomes.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; approved by roll call vote.
- **00:56:26 Community Corrections Financial Transfer**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda, Community Corrections.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred funds for the Community Transition Program (CTP) recovery coach and home detention case manager from the DOC grant/CTP fund into project income lines due to state funding uncertainty.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; approved by roll call vote.
- **00:58:04 Highway Department Financial Transfer**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie, County Highway.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** **00:57:36** Transferred \$24,000 from repair/maintenance supplies to vehicles (4537) to purchase a used 2004 Gradall equipment vehicle from Grant County as a backup for culvert placement and storm debris removal.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; approved by roll call vote.
- **00:59:57 High-Tech Crime Unit Financial Transfer**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chuck Zimmer, HCU Director.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred funds within the high-tech crime fund to cover operating supplies and consumable hardware (hard drives) as balances run low.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; approved by roll call vote.
- **01:01:46 Opioid Response Appropriation / Transfer**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred \$2,700 from adult user fees to opioid response kiosk lines to properly account for grant-reimbursed kiosk bills.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; approved by roll call vote.
- **01:02:52 CASA Grant Appropriation (Vet Bills & Director Restructuring)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
  - **Deliberation Summary:**
    - **01:02:42** Appropriated \$3,000 for veterinary bills for retiring facility dog "Frankie."
    - **01:03:43** Appropriated \$23,576 (\$10,500 salary, \$13,76 health insurance) out of the CASA grant to cover the restructured attorney-director position, PTO payouts, and health insurance.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motions to approve made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; approved by roll call votes.
- **01:05:07 EMS Capital Improvements Appropriation**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley, EMS.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriated \$10,593 for two insurance deductibles (resulting from minor vehicle bumps) and to replace seven heavy-duty 24/7 station recliners.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; approved by roll call vote.
- **01:08:06 & 01:08:32 Community Crossings Matching Grant & Road Appropriations**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie / Highway Department.
  - **Deliberation Summary:**
    - Appropriated \$294,594.75 (1173) as local match for Community Crossings paving projects (Walnut Street, 650 South, and 650 East).
    - Appropriated \$418,750 (2076), combining the state/local community crossings funds and returning lower-than-awarded 2024 grant balances back to INDOT.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motions to approve made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; approved by roll call votes.
- **01:13:06 Resolution 2025-08: Department Budget Breakouts**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Auditor's Office.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** **01:13:56** Resolution requiring individual department budgets to break out explicit employee salary, benefit, and insurance costs rather than holding these funds centrally in the commissioners' budget. This

reorganization is budget-neutral overall but provides transparent, accurate tracking per department.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; passed by roll call vote.
- **01:16:36 Council Rules Amendments (Old Business)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** President Freeman.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** **01:17:16** Reviewed updates to Council Rules, including shifting the deadline for ordinances and resolutions to be distributed in final form from Friday at 9:00 a.m. to Thursday at noon, and minor clerical corrections regarding county sheriff attendance and agenda sequencing.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve amendments made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; approved by roll call vote.

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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No members of the public signed up for or spoke during the open public comment period.*  
**01:29:49**

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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - **01:22:14** Auditor's office and administration discussed the upcoming budget submission timeline under Resolution 2025-08. Departments will be guided through electronic spreadsheet breakouts, with initial targets around June 1st, alleviating panic regarding sudden deadlines.
  - **01:24:43** Gavin Green (County Coroner) provided quarterly and monthly case statistics (158 total cases YTD) and introduced a new scheduling and on-call hour tracking program.
  - **01:30:26** Reminders were shared regarding the free Property Fraud Alert system available through the auditor/recorder's office.
  - **01:31:21** Council members warned of incoming budget contractions due to Senate Enrolled Act 1 and urged departments to find expenditure reductions. Farmers also reminded motorists to watch for slow-moving agricultural equipment on roadways.
- **Adjournment:** **01:32:32** Motion to adjourn made by Jessica, seconded by Dan; approved by roll call vote.